

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS (AI)**

4 SUNDAR PICHAI, 50
CEO, GOOGLE

THE INTELLIGENT DISRUPTOR

BECAUSE under Pichai's leadership, Google is leveraging AI to develop a slew of world-changing products, from autonomously-written emails to Bard, Google's conversational AI, which was launched in India on May 11 this year

BECAUSE Receiving the Padma Bhushan in 2022, Pichai said, "India is a part of me. I carry it with me wherever I go."

BECAUSE Pichai is one of the highest-paid executives in the business, with his 2022 compensation topping $226 million. The lion's share—about $218 million—was in the form of stock awards

HOME GROWN **Pichai was recently in the news when his ancestral home in Chennai's Ashok Nagar was sold to Tamil cinema actor and producer C. Manikandan. Per reports, the Google CEO lived in this home till he was about 20, leaving Chennai in 1989 to pursue a degree in Metallurgical Engineering at IIT Kharagpur**

5 GITA GOPINATH, 51
FIRST DEPUTY MANAGING DIRECTOR, IMF

MONETARY MAESTRA

BECAUSE in her role as the first deputy managing director of the International Monetary Fund since January 2022, she has earned admiration as she represents the Fund at multilateral forums, maintains high-level contacts with governments and board members, and leads the Fund's work on surveillance and related policies

BECAUSE in her former role as IMF's chief economist, she came up with proposals to end the pandemic, including vaccinating 60 per cent of the world's population and ensuring widespread testing and tracing

COUNTING LESSONS **Born into a middle-class Malayali family based in Kolkata, her father would arrange vegetables on a table in groups to teach her multiplication at the age of seven**

BECAUSE she is much sought-after for her views on global economic issues, be it geopolitical and inflation risks or cracks in monetary policies of central banks

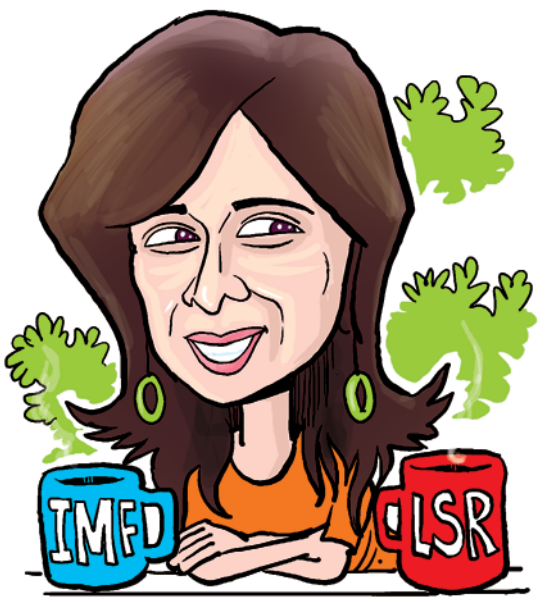


Illustration by **MANJUL**